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Top Skills

Board Governance

Non-Executive Independent Director

Organizational Leadership

Parag Agarawal

Business Growth & Transformation Leader | Founder Partner,
Unconsult | National Head – Portfolio Success, Wadhwani
Foundation | Independent Director | Scaling Businesses Through
Strategy, Product, GTM & AI

New Delhi, Delhi, India

Summary

Businesses rarely struggle because they lack opportunity. More often, they struggle because growth outpaces leadership, execution and operating discipline. Sustainable scale isn't created by a single breakthrough idea, it comes from aligning strategy, people, processes, technology and execution around a common goal. For over 23 years, I have helped build, scale and transform businesses across SaaS, Internet, Healthcare, Media, FMCG and EdTech. From founder-led ventures to listed organizations, my focus has remained the same, creating businesses that grow profitably, scale sustainably and deliver long-term value. Over the course of my career, I have led businesses through rapid expansion, market entry, business transformation, IPO readiness, acquisitions and post-merger integration. This includes managing businesses exceeding #900 crore in revenue, building and leading organizations of 2,200+ professionals, expanding into 30+ markets, and contributing to three IPO journeys and #200+ crore M&A initiatives. Today, I bring this operating experience to three complementary roles. As Founder Partner at Unconsult, I partner with founders, CEOs and leadership teams to solve growth challenges, redesign operating models and build scalable commercial organizations. As National Head – Portfolio Success at Wadhwani Foundation, I work with founder-led businesses to strengthen execution, improve go-to-market effectiveness, build export readiness and develop capabilities required for the next stage of growth. As an Independent Director, I contribute to governance, strategy, risk oversight and long-term value creation while helping organizations balance growth with disciplined decision-making. My work spans business strategy, growth, business transformation, go-to-market, customer success, pricing, organizational design, AI-enabled business transformation and leadership development. While AI is changing how businesses operate, I believe technology creates value only when it simplifies

decisions, strengthens execution and improves business outcomes. I enjoy working with founders, CEOs, boards, investors and leadership teams tackling complex business challenges—whether that's scaling revenue, entering new markets, improving profitability, transforming operating models or preparing for the next phase of growth. My belief is simple: businesses don't scale because they grow; they scale because their leadership, operating model and execution evolve faster than their complexity.

Experience

Wadhwani Foundation

Portfolio Success

February 2026 - Present (6 months)

India

At Wadhwani Foundation, I lead Portfolio Success, partnering with founder-led businesses to accelerate profitable growth, strengthen execution capabilities and build organizations that are ready for the next stage of scale. Working across a diverse portfolio of high-growth enterprises, my focus is on helping founders move beyond entrepreneurial dependence by building disciplined operating models, scalable commercial engines and leadership capability. My work spans the complete growth journey—from diagnosing business challenges and identifying growth levers to improving go-to-market effectiveness, strengthening execution discipline and preparing businesses for expansion, exports and investment readiness. Rather than providing advisory recommendations alone, I work closely with founders and leadership teams to translate strategy into measurable business outcomes through structured execution and capability building.

A significant part of the role involves developing repeatable frameworks that can be deployed across hundreds of businesses, enabling consistent decision-making, stronger governance, performance visibility and sustainable growth. I also work with ecosystem partners, industry experts and internal teams to build scalable interventions that improve business performance while creating employment and long-term economic impact.

With AI increasingly becoming part of every business conversation, my approach is to integrate AI where it creates tangible business value—improving decision-making, simplifying operations, enhancing customer engagement and enabling leadership teams to execute with greater speed and clarity.

Key Focus Areas

- Business Growth & Transformation
- Founder & CEO Advisory
- Strategy & Business Scaling
- Go-to-Market Transformation
- Export Readiness
- Operating Model Design
- AI-enabled Business Transformation
- Leadership Capability Development
- Performance Management & Governance
- Investment Readiness

Unconsult

Founder Partner

February 2024 - Present (2 years 6 months)

Noida

Helping founders, CEOs and leadership teams build businesses that scale profitably. At Unconsult, I partner with organizations to solve growth challenges, redesign operating models and translate strategy into disciplined execution.

My work combines over two decades of operating experience across large enterprises, founder-led businesses and listed companies to help organizations improve growth, profitability and execution. Every engagement begins with understanding the business model, identifying the highest-impact growth levers and building practical execution roadmaps that deliver measurable outcomes.

Typical engagements include:

- Business Growth & Transformation
- Growth Strategy & Business Scaling
- Go-to-Market Strategy
- Business Model & Operating Model Redesign
- AI-enabled Business Transformation
- Customer Success & Commercial Performance
- Pricing & Monetization
- Leadership Advisory & Change Management

- Commercial Due Diligence & M&A Support

Industries / type of companies I work with

- SMBs - 50-200 Cr revenue, have an idea and ambition, but unable to grow
- B2B SaaS - companies looking to grow aggressively in B2B
- Healthcare - Medtech, Hospitals, M&A, Pharma
- FMCG - Ecommerce / Quick Commerce, GTM - GT/MT expansion.

Zee Learn Ltd

Independent Director

August 2025 - Present (1 year)

Serve on the Board as an Independent Director, contributing to governance, long-term strategy and sustainable value creation. Drawing on over two decades of operating and transformation experience, I work with the Board and management to support strategic decision-making, strengthen governance and help the organization navigate growth, change and emerging business opportunities.

My contribution extends beyond statutory governance to bringing an operator's perspective into board deliberations—balancing long-term strategic priorities with execution realities across business transformation, organizational capability, risk management and commercial growth.

Edukemy

Building Yooki

January 2025 - Present (1 year 7 months)

New Delhi

Partnering with the founding team to build Yooki, an AI-enabled learning platform for competitive exam aspirants. Working at the intersection of product strategy, business model, customer insights and go-to-market to transform a product idea into a scalable business.

My role focuses on ensuring that product decisions are driven by user needs, business outcomes and long-term scalability. Working closely with founders, product and technology teams, I help shape product strategy, user experience, growth initiatives, monetization and AI-enabled learning journeys.

The experience reflects my belief that successful products are built by aligning customer problems, business strategy and disciplined execution—not technology alone.

Shalby Limited

Chief Business Officer

November 2022 - January 2024 (1 year 3 months)

Ahmedabad

Joined Shalby to lead strategic growth initiatives beyond the core hospital business, with a mandate to identify, build and scale new revenue streams while supporting inorganic growth and business expansion. The role combined business strategy, healthcare innovation, M&A, new venture development and commercial execution to strengthen the organization's long-term growth platform.

Led multiple strategic initiatives across hospital expansion, specialty healthcare, digital health and strategic investments. Worked closely with leadership on evaluating new business opportunities, assessing acquisition targets, developing scalable healthcare models and building partnerships that supported sustainable growth.

Key initiatives included launching the Shalby Orthopaedics Centres of Excellence (SOCE), expanding the organization's presence through new specialty centres, evaluating over 100 hospital acquisition opportunities, leading the commercial and strategic evaluation of the Sanar International Hospital acquisition, and supporting investor discussions and post-acquisition integration.

Also led the incubation of Hosply, Shalby's digital healthcare marketplace, establishing the commercial model, validating market fit and building an early growth engine that onboarded 180+ hospitals while achieving an annualized revenue run rate of ₹60 lakh within the pilot phase.

Key Business Outcomes

Launched three Shalby Orthopaedics Centres of Excellence in Lucknow, Gwalior and Ranchi.

Evaluated 100+ hospitals for expansion, acquisition and strategic partnerships.

Led commercial evaluation, negotiations and integration planning for the Sanar International Hospital acquisition.

Built and validated Hosply's commercial model, onboarding 180+ hospitals during the pilot phase.

Strengthened Shalby's expansion strategy through new business development and strategic growth initiatives.

IndiaMART InterMESH Limited

SVP - Client Servicing and Product Marketing

April 2018 - November 2022 (4 years 8 months)

Noida

Returned to IndiaMART at a pivotal stage in its growth journey to lead one of the organization's largest business functions and build a scalable commercial and customer success engine capable of supporting the company's next phase of growth as a publicly listed enterprise.

Led a nationwide organization spanning Customer Success, Inside Sales, Field Sales, Customer Retention, Renewals, Collections, Product Marketing, Learning & Development and Commercial Operations. The role extended beyond functional leadership to building the operating rhythm, leadership capability, data-driven decision making and execution discipline required to scale consistently across geographies and customer segments.

Worked closely with the leadership team to strengthen customer engagement, improve product adoption, drive renewals, enhance commercial performance and align product, technology and business teams around customer outcomes. A strong focus throughout the journey was on simplifying complexity, institutionalising processes and building leaders who could sustain growth at scale.

Key initiatives included redesigning customer engagement models, strengthening sales and customer success processes, improving performance management, building leadership capability, driving digital adoption and creating scalable operating frameworks that improved execution consistency across the organisation.

Key Highlights

- Built and led one of India's largest Customer Success organisations, scaling the team from approximately 300 to over 2,200 people
- Managed business portfolios exceeding #900/#1000 crore in annual revenue.
- Played a key leadership role during IndiaMART's transition into a listed company, strengthening execution and commercial governance.
- Built high-performing leadership teams and execution frameworks that enabled sustainable growth at scale.

- Partnered cross-functionally with Product, Technology, Marketing and Finance to improve customer experience and business outcomes.

Aakash Educational Services Limited

COO

December 2017 - April 2018 (5 months)

Greater Delhi Area

Joined Aakash to strengthen business operations and support the next phase of organizational growth by improving execution, operating effectiveness and commercial performance. Worked closely with the leadership team on scaling operational capabilities, driving cross-functional alignment and building processes to support business expansion.

The experience further strengthened my understanding of managing large, multi-location service organizations and prepared me for the subsequent opportunity to lead large-scale commercial and customer success transformation at IndiaMART.

IndiaMART InterMESH Limited

SVP - Client Servicing

September 2015 - December 2017 (2 years 4 months)

Greater Delhi Area

Joined IndiaMART during a high-growth phase to strengthen Customer Success, Product Marketing and commercial effectiveness as the business expanded its digital marketplace for SMEs across India. The mandate was to improve customer outcomes, increase product adoption and build scalable post-sales capabilities that could support rapid business growth.

Worked closely with Product, Sales and Technology teams to redesign customer engagement, strengthen onboarding and lifecycle management, improve customer communication and establish structured customer success practices. The role also involved driving product marketing initiatives, enabling customer-centric product adoption and creating feedback mechanisms that helped align market needs with product development.

This experience provided the opportunity to build scalable customer engagement frameworks, develop cross-functional operating models and establish execution practices that improved customer experience while supporting business growth. The learnings from this phase laid the foundation

for my return to IndiaMART in 2018 to lead the organisation's customer and commercial functions at a much larger scale.

Key Highlights

- Strengthened Customer Success and Product Marketing functions to support rapid business growth.
- Built scalable customer engagement and lifecycle management frameworks.
- Improved collaboration between Product, Sales and Customer Success to enhance customer outcomes.
- Established structured processes that supported product adoption, customer retention and long-term customer value.

HT Media Ltd

9 years 5 months

Head - New Revenue Generation and Business Intelligence

April 2013 - September 2015 (2 years 6 months)

Greater Delhi Area

Led organization-wide initiatives focused on developing new revenue streams, strengthening business intelligence and enabling data-driven decision-making. Worked across business, sales, marketing and leadership teams to identify growth opportunities, evaluate emerging business models and build analytical frameworks that improved commercial effectiveness.

This role brought together customer insight, commercial strategy, analytics and business innovation—providing the foundation for my subsequent leadership roles in business transformation, customer success and enterprise growth.

The decade at HT Media shaped my understanding of how customer insight, commercial execution and leadership come together to build businesses that scale.

Head - Strategy and Special Projects (additional responsibility)

June 2009 - April 2013 (3 years 11 months)

Greater Delhi Area

Led national circulation sales initiatives focused on expanding market reach, strengthening distribution networks and improving execution across multiple geographies. Worked with cross-functional teams to align sales, circulation and marketing efforts, creating scalable market expansion strategies and stronger channel effectiveness.

The experience strengthened my understanding of managing distributed teams, market expansion and execution at scale.

Business Head - Hindustan, Delhi & NCR

July 2010 - March 2013 (2 years 9 months)

Greater Delhi Area

Led the P&L for one of Hindustan's largest and most competitive markets, with responsibility for revenue growth, profitability, market development and cross-functional business performance. Partnered with editorial, circulation, sales and marketing teams to strengthen customer engagement, improve commercial outcomes and drive sustainable business growth.

The role reinforced the importance of balancing strategic priorities with disciplined execution while leading large teams in a highly competitive market.

National Circulation Sales Head - Hindustan

August 2009 - July 2010 (1 year)

Greater Delhi Area

Led national circulation sales initiatives focused on expanding market reach, strengthening distribution networks and improving execution across multiple geographies. Worked with cross-functional teams to align sales, circulation and marketing efforts, creating scalable market expansion strategies and stronger channel effectiveness.

The experience strengthened my understanding of managing distributed teams, market expansion and execution at scale.

Business Manager - Hindustan

July 2008 - July 2010 (2 years 1 month)

Greater Delhi Area

Transitioned into frontline business leadership with responsibility for driving B2B advertising revenue, strengthening customer relationships and expanding market presence. Built a strong understanding of consultative selling, key account management and commercial execution while working with businesses across diverse industry segments.

Expanded the network in UP, from 2 units to 12 units over a period of 6 years from 2006-2012. A journey started in 2005 with Meerut and change in Brand identity, helped in creating a brand which became the second largest read newspaper in the country

This role established the commercial foundation that continues to influence my approach to building scalable sales organizations and expansion into newer geographies.

Product Manager and Marketing Manager

May 2006 - July 2008 (2 years 3 months)

Greater Delhi Area

Started my career at the intersection of product management and marketing, developing a deep understanding of customer behaviour, market segmentation and value proposition design. Worked closely with editorial, circulation, sales and marketing teams to strengthen product positioning, improve customer acquisition and align business decisions with market insights.

Created new Brand Hindustan, relaunching the newspaper, with new Brand Identity for customers of the new millenium.

This role laid the foundation for my customer-first approach to business growth—an approach that has shaped every leadership role since.

Heinz India

3 years 3 months

Brand Manager - Dilmah

May 2005 - July 2006 (1 year 3 months)

Mumbai Metropolitan Region

Led brand development and market expansion initiatives for the premium tea portfolio, working across brand strategy, channel development, trade marketing and business growth. The role strengthened my understanding of brand building, consumer behaviour, premium positioning and integrated go-to-market execution, providing an early foundation in creating customer value through strong brands.

Asst Manager - Sales and Trade Marketing

May 2003 - April 2005 (2 years)

Mumbai Metropolitan Region

Started my FMCG sales journey with Heinz, building a strong foundation in structured sales execution, channel management and distributor-led market development. Worked closely with distributors, retailers and field teams to strengthen market presence, improve execution quality and drive business growth across assigned territories.

The role provided first-hand experience in territory planning, route-to-market strategy, retail execution, merchandising, channel partner management and sales analytics—instilling the commercial discipline and execution rigor that has remained central to my leadership approach throughout my career.

Wipro Technologies

System / VLSI Design Engineer

June 2000 - May 2001 (1 year)

Education

Indian Institute of Management, Ahmedabad

PGDM, Major - Sales and Marketing Minor - Business Strategy · (2001 - 2003)

Wharton Executive Education

Strategic Thinking and Leadership Program, Business Strategy and Leadership Management · (2020 - 2020)

Indian Institute of Technology (Banaras Hindu University), Varanasi

B. Tech., Electronics & Communication Engineering · (1996 - 2000)

AGSM @ UNSW Business School

Master of Business Administration - MBA, Exchange Program · (October 2002 - December 2002)